

5.1 Composing Shots And Other Techniques

No doubt you've often encountered shots where the wrong thing is taking attention away from the subject of the shot. Many times, this is due to bad lighting (which we'll come to later), but it could just as well be a mistake in composing the shot—the position of your subject inside the frame can make a world of difference.



Now this image wouldn't look as good if the Sun was in the middle of the shot

The Rule Of Thirds

Contrary to popular belief, the best place for your subject *isn't* the centre of the frame—it's a little off-centre. To be precise, imagine the frame divided into nine parts by two horizontal and two vertical lines. The best places for the subject are at the intersections of the horizontal and vertical lines. This is called the Rule of Thirds, since the subject will be located at the one or two-third mark along the length or breadth of the frame.